

Keep the momentum. Collect the idea.

Implementation handoff for Codex

Post-lesson continuation + collectible Ideas system

Prepared October 5, 2026

Product goal

Finishing one idea should naturally lead to the next, while every completed idea becomes a useful collectible object the learner can revisit later. The experience should feel polished and lightly game-like without turning learning into XP, streaks, or a noisy reward system.

Scope locked for this patch

- **Next-idea completion flow.** The completion screen becomes the deliberate barrier between ideas. The learner can continue forward without returning to the book list.
- **Ideas collection.** Completing the lesson and its quiz earns an Idea Card. Perfect quiz accuracy is not required.
- **Favorite treatment.** A gold star activates a visible animated edge glow/shimmer in both carousel and grid views. Favorite is separate from earned.
- **Two collection views.** A focused horizontal card carousel and a two-column, vertically scrolling, controlled-stagger grid inspired by the supplied Siri layout reference.
- **Card flip.** Front is bottom-line-first. Back is useful detail: application, source book/author, earned state/date, and Review lesson.
- **iPad now, not later.** Use the same system in a centered, wider two-column window. Do not defer basic iPad support to a later version; a sidebar redesign is not required in this patch.
- **Accessibility and restraint.** Motion is purposeful, not constant spectacle. Reduce Motion, VoiceOver, Dynamic Type and Differentiate Without Color must remain first-class.

Baseline and branch rule

Repository: **Patchagray/LifeIsLearned**

Accepted engineering baseline: **feature/handoff-003-content-limits** (Handoff 003 implementation anchored at **f78c7f1781b6fa2087559d138c2b4947b0dcfc52**, followed by evidence/documentation commits). Branch from the latest accepted Handoff 003 branch head, not the older bootstrap or Handoff 002 branch.

Follow AGENTS.md. Preserve the existing signing configuration, persistence/recovery guarantees, manual Files importer, narration behavior, authoring limits, and current content packages. Do not merge automatically.

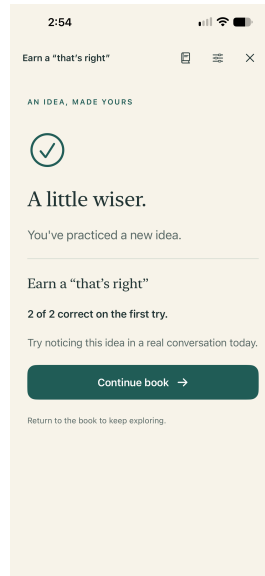
Explicit non-goals

Do not change the storyteller/guide voice system in this patch. Do not add cloud distribution, accounts, XP, streaks, rarity tiers, social sharing, or a new import format solely for cards. Do not rewrite imported book content.

Visual references and interpretation

Reference A - current completion screen

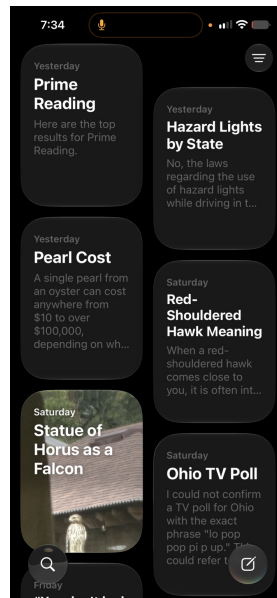
The current completion screen is visually clean, but its primary action sends the learner back to the book before they can continue. Preserve the calm editorial tone; change the action hierarchy.



Current device screen supplied by Mario.

Reference B - desired grid rhythm

The Siri reference is about **layout rhythm only**: two large columns, vertically staggered, comfortable card size, long vertical scroll, and no rigid checkerboard rows. Life Is Learned cards must retain their own editorial visual identity.



Layout reference supplied by Mario. Do not copy Siri styling, colors, or card content.

1. Post-lesson continuation flow

Completion screen action hierarchy

The completion screen itself is the barrier. Do **not** add a second confirmation dialog that asks whether the learner wants to continue.

- **Primary:** Continue to next idea ->. Show the next idea title directly under or inside the action area. If the next idea is partially complete, resume its saved position. The tap is explicit permission to enter the next idea; reuse the app's normal playback-start behavior rather than adding a separate autoplay rule.
- **Secondary:** Back to book. This returns to the ordered idea list.
- **Tertiary:** View collected card or Review this idea. Review must not clear completion or first-attempt score.
- **Final idea:** replace the forward action with Finish book, returning to the book detail in its completed state. Do not invent an endless loop.

Card earned state on completion

When practice completes, surface a restrained confirmation such as **Idea collected**. A small card preview or card icon is acceptable. Do not replace the completion message with a loot-box-style reveal. The learning result remains primary.

Navigation edge cases

- If the next sequential idea is unstated, open it normally.
- If it is in progress, resume its saved destination.
- If it is already complete, use a review-forward label rather than pretending it is new.
- If the current idea is the final active idea, use Finish book.
- Closing the completion screen or choosing Back to book must not start audio.

Acceptance

A learner can complete Idea 3, tap Continue to next idea, land in Idea 4 without visiting the book list, and still choose Back to book or review the completed idea instead. Existing resume, narration, quiz, scoring, and persistence behavior remains intact.

2. Idea Cards: earn once, keep forever

Earning rule

An Idea Card is earned when the lesson reaches **practiceComplete**. The learner does not need 2/2 correct on the first attempt. The quiz is practice, not a gatekeeping exam.

Card content: use existing authored data

Do not force a formatVersion change for Handoff 004. The current lesson model already contains enough high-quality content to build the card:

Card surface	Source
Front title	Lesson.title
Front bottom line	Takeaway page text
Back: Put it to work	Lesson.subtitle (learning objective)
Back: From	Book.title + Book.author
Back: Earned	Persisted earned date; use "Earned previously" when migrated date is unknowable
Back action	Review lesson

Bottom line up front

The front should say the useful thing immediately. Avoid paragraphs. The lesson title can be smaller; the takeaway is the visual center of gravity. The back is for context and practical use.

Persist card-specific state separately from lesson progress

Add a small persisted card record keyed by the semantic idea identity: **bookID + lessonID**. Do not key ownership or favorite state only to revision, because the same core idea can be revised.

IdeaCardRecord should retain at least: bookID, lessonID, earnedAt (optional for migration), lastEarnedRevision, isFavorite, and a compact display snapshot (idea title, takeaway, application line, book title, author). The snapshot preserves a collected card even if a later full-collection update removes that idea.

Revision behavior

- Same stable idea ID, newer revision: keep the card, favorite, and original earned date. Until the learner completes the newer revision, show a small **Updated - review again** state and preserve the previously earned snapshot.
- After completing the newer revision: refresh the snapshot, update lastEarnedRevision, retain favorite and original earned date.
- Removed idea: keep an already-earned card as archived; do not silently erase something the learner collected.
- Truly different concept: authoring rules already require a new stable idea ID. It therefore earns a separate card.

3. Card visual system and favorite animation

Front

- Portrait collectible-card proportion, approximately 0.72-0.76 width/height ratio.
- Small idea title or number near the top; large takeaway/bottom-line text in the center; book title/author quietly anchored near the bottom.
- Use the existing editorial palette and book identity. Avoid fake rarity labels, loud gradients, dense metadata, or tiny body copy.

Back

- **Put it to work:** the lesson subtitle / learning objective, edited only through authored content - not generated at runtime.
- **From:** book title and author.
- **Earned:** date or Earned previously.
- **Review lesson** -> action. If archived, explain that the idea came from an earlier collection revision and still allow review when source content is available.

Flip behavior

In the focused carousel, tapping the card body flips front/back with a restrained 3D Y rotation. The favorite star is a separate hit target and must not trigger a flip. Under Reduce Motion, use a short crossfade/scale transition instead of 3D rotation. VoiceOver exposes explicit "Show details" / "Show front" actions rather than requiring a visual flip gesture.

Favorite activation

- A visible gold star toggles favorite. Use a light success haptic when enabled.
- On activation, run one satisfying 350-550 ms edge-light sweep and a tiny sparkle accent. Avoid particle storms.
- Idle favorite state keeps a **subtle animated perimeter**: thin gold/amber edge, low-amplitude glow, and a slow shimmer/pulse. It must remain visible in both carousel and grid.
- Grid animation must be cheap: animate only realized/visible cells; do not keep dozens of offscreen timers alive. Favor a simple gradient-phase or opacity pulse over heavy particle systems.
- Reduce Motion: static gold edge + filled star, no continuous shimmer. Differentiate Without Color: filled star/icon and accessibility label ensure favorite is not conveyed by gold alone.

Motion hierarchy

Primary motion = carousel and card flip. Secondary motion = favorite activation and low-key edge shimmer. Tertiary motion = ordinary screen transitions. Never animate everything at once.

4. Ideas collection views

Entry point

Add an **Ideas** entry in the Home toolbar/navigation area, preferably the leading/top-left action. Use a recognizable card/stack symbol and accessibility label "Ideas". Keep Import and Settings discoverable; do not place a large new dashboard button in the Home content.

Focused carousel - reflection mode

- One large centered card. Previous and next cards peek from the sides.
- Horizontal swipe with native paging/view-aligned behavior. Gentle scale/depth is acceptable; avoid dramatic 3D wheel distortion.
- Tap card body to flip. Tap star to favorite. Show current position and a compact book/source label.
- This is the default reflective experience when opening a specific card from the grid or completion screen.

Staggered grid - browse mode

On normal iPhone text sizes, use exactly **two columns**. Do not use a standard row-aligned LazyVGrid. Implement a deterministic controlled stagger that produces the supplied Siri-like rhythm.

Recommended implementation: two vertical lazy stacks inside one horizontal container. Even-indexed cards feed the left stack. Odd-indexed cards feed the right stack with a fixed top offset of roughly 35-45% of one card height. Use consistent card width/aspect ratio and a predictable vertical gap. This creates rhythm without random placement or layout reordering.

- Cards remain large thumbnail versions of the real card, not icons. Show enough of the bottom line to recognize the idea, plus source/favorite state.
- Tapping a grid card opens that card in the focused carousel. Do not attempt a tiny inline 3D flip inside the grid.
- Vertical scroll only. Preserve stable ordering so cards do not jump between columns as favorite/filter state changes.

Filters and sort

Keep controls compact: **All**, **Favorites**, and **Book** filtering; sort by **Recently earned**, **Book order**, or **Alphabetical**. Avoid a filter control that consumes more space than the cards.

Empty states

No cards: "Finish an idea to collect your first card." Favorites empty: "Star an idea you want to keep close." Filters must always provide a simple route back to All.

5. iPad and accessibility are part of this patch

iPad - no separate v2 required

Use the same carousel and two-column staggered grid now. Center the collection in a constrained content window instead of stretching cards across the full screen. Increase card size and breathing room moderately. A sidebar + permanent detail pane may be explored later, but is not required for Handoff 004.

- Suggested grid content max width: roughly 760-900 pt depending on orientation and safe area.
- Keep two columns at normal Dynamic Type. Landscape should remain centered rather than expanding to 3-5 columns.
- Focused carousel may use a larger card but should not become oversized enough to require head movement or long eye travel.

Dynamic Type

The two-column rule applies to normal text sizes. At accessibility Dynamic Type categories, switch to **one column** rather than clipping, shrinking typography, or hiding the takeaway. This is the deliberate accessibility exception to the two-column visual rule.

VoiceOver

- Each card is one coherent element with title, takeaway, source, earned/favorite state, and actions: Open, Favorite/Unfavorite, Show details.
- Grid order must match visible reading order. If using two independent stacks, provide an accessibility container order that remains predictable top-to-bottom rather than exposing implementation-column order.
- Favorite shimmer is decorative and ignored by accessibility.

Contrast, motion and touch

- Gold favorite state must meet contrast requirements where it communicates state. The filled star/icon provides a non-color cue.
- Minimum 44 x 44 pt hit targets for star, view toggle, filters, and completion actions.
- Reduce Motion removes 3D flips, carousel flourish, continuous shimmer, and sparkle while preserving clear state changes.
- Do not shrink card text below readable system sizes to preserve the layout.

6. Implementation map

Likely model/persistence additions

Models/IdeaCardRecord.swift - semantic ownership/favorite/earned metadata + compact card snapshot.

Models/IdeaCardPresentation.swift (optional) - resolves active lesson content vs archived snapshot and Updated state.

CollectionStorage / LibraryStore - load/save/recover idea-card state with the existing atomic library snapshot workflow. Missing pre-H004 card files are a migration state, not corruption.

Likely views

Views/IdeaCollectionView.swift

Views/IdeaCardView.swift

Views/IdeaCardGrid.swift

Views/IdeaCardCarousel.swift

Views/FavoriteCardBorder.swift

Update LessonCompletionView.swift, LibraryView.swift / Home toolbar, and navigation destinations as needed.

Do not change import schema for this feature

Derive the card from existing lesson/book fields and persist the earned snapshot locally. Handoff 004 should not require re-exporting The Influential Mind or Never Split the Difference merely to make cards work. If implementation reveals a genuine schema blocker, stop and document it rather than casually changing formatVersion 2.

State transitions

Earn: when practice transitions to complete, upsert IdeaCardRecord.

Favorite: toggle only card state; never mutate lesson progress.

Revision update: retain ownership/favorite/date; mark review needed until the new revision is completed.

Removal: retain snapshot as archived card.

Review: opening a completed lesson from a card does not reset completion or first-attempt scoring.

Migration from existing progress

On first launch after this patch, backfill a card for every currently or historically completed lesson that can be resolved from stored content/history. If the actual completion timestamp was never stored, **do not fabricate a date**; display "Earned previously". Favorites begin false for migrated cards unless state already exists.

Performance

Use lazy containers. Keep favorite animation lightweight and only active for realized visible cards. Decode/use artwork through the existing cache/path. Do not duplicate base64 assets into card records. Card snapshots store only small text metadata.

7. Acceptance tests and evidence

Automated behavior

- Completing a lesson after an incorrect first attempt still earns exactly one card. Replaying/recompleting does not duplicate it.
- Perfect and imperfect quiz results both earn cards after practice completion; first-attempt score remains accurate.
- Completion -> Continue next idea navigates to the sequential idea without passing through Book Detail. In-progress next ideas resume correctly. Final idea uses Finish book.
- Favorite persists across relaunch, book metadata changes, reordering, and same-ID lesson revision. Updating a lesson does not silently erase the card or favorite.
- Completing a newer revision refreshes the card snapshot while retaining original earned date and favorite.
- Removing an earned idea from a later full collection retains an archived card. Removing an unearned idea creates no card.
- Existing completed progress migrates into cards without fabricating earned timestamps.
- Grid filter/sort does not change card identity or favorite state. Stable ordering is deterministic.
- VoiceOver reading order for staggered grid is intentional and independent of the internal left/right stack implementation.
- Reduce Motion produces no continuous favorite animation and no 3D flip.

Visual evidence required

- iPhone: completion screen with next-idea action, carousel front, carousel back, favorite active, staggered grid, Favorites filter, and empty state.
- iPad portrait and landscape: centered two-column staggered grid and focused carousel.
- Large text / accessibility size: one-column fallback with readable card content.
- Light and dark appearance; favorite edge must remain visible in both.

Device check

On a physical iPhone: earn a card, favorite/unfavorite it, leave/relaunch, browse grid and carousel, flip it, continue directly into the next idea, and review the previous idea. Record whether animations remain smooth with at least 20 synthetic cards and several favorites. Simulator screenshots do not prove animation quality.

Deliverable

Commit implementation, tests, screenshots/evidence, and a concise Handoff004 evidence report to a dedicated branch based on accepted Handoff 003. Push the branch and identify the exact tested implementation commit. Separate simulator/device observations from automated assertions. Do not merge by default. **The bar is not merely that the screen exists:** review spacing, typography, card scale, stagger rhythm, flip behavior, and favorite glow on actual rendered screens before calling the UI complete.